SCHOLASTIC SCOPE

Subject-Verb Agreement
THE LAZY EDITOR: "Get Me Outta Here!" pages 30-31
October 2016

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

Can We Agree?

A verb should agree with its subject. In other words:

If the subject is singular, use a singular verb. If the subject is plural, use a plural verb:

Allison *sits* alone.

Those newspapers *are* old.

Sometimes, it can be a bit tricky to figure out whether the subject is singular or plural. Here are some tips:

When the subject consists of two or more nouns or pronouns connected by *and*, use a plural verb:

My sister and I *are* going to the movies.

Use a singular verb with sums of money or periods of time:

I think eight dollars *is* a good price for the dance.

Four hours *is* a long time to wait.

When two or more singular nouns or pronouns are connected by *or* or *nor*, use a singular verb:

Is your mom or dad home?

Collective nouns are nouns that describe a group, such as *team, committee, class,* and *family*. When all the members of the group are doing the same thing, use a singular verb:

My team *has* so much fun playing together.

When the members of the group are acting as individuals, use a plural verb:

The majority of my friends *are* going to the party on Friday.

The words *each, each one, either, neither, everyone, everybody, anybody, anyone, nobody, somebody, someone,* and *no one* are singular and require a singular verb:

Nobody *eats* the cake.

Directions: In each sentence that follows, underline the subject and circle the correct verb from the pair of verbs in parentheses. We did the first one for you.

1. Some T-shirts in this pile **is/(are)** yours.

2. Some parts of your essay **need/needs** revisions.

3. Most of these clothes **is/are** too small for me.

4. The movie **are/is** three hours long? I'm going to wait until I can stream it and watch it on my couch.

©2016 BY SCHOLASTIC INC. TEACHERS MAY PROJECT OR MAKE COPIES OF THIS PAGE TO DISTRIBUTE TO STUDENTS.

5. All the dancers in the show **say/says** their feet hurt after a performance.

6. Jared and his friends **plan/plans** to come to my party.

7. Neither of the books I wanted **is/are** in stock.

8. The necklaces in the jewelry store **cost/costs** $15 each.

Directions: In each sentence below, circle the subject that agrees with the verb. We did the first one for you.

9. The **flower/flowers** in my grandmother's garden are in bloom.

10. The **sink/sinks** in my kitchen has a leak.

11. The **signs/sign** on the street seems to be incorrect.

12. The **kitten/kittens** in the pet store are adorable.

Directions: For each sentence below, check one of the boxes to indicate whether the verb in boldface is correct or incorrect. Then explain your answer. We've done the first one for you.

13. My teacher and her family **is** going on vacation this week. ☐ **correct** ☑ **incorrect**

Explanation: The subject is composed of two nouns (teacher and family) connected by "and."

14. Each of those desserts **looks** delicious, but I'm full. ☐ **correct** ☐ **incorrect**

Explanation: _____

15. The fans cheer wildly each time their team **score** a point. ☐ **correct** ☐ **incorrect**

Explanation: _____

©2016 BY SCHOLASTIC INC. TEACHERS MAY PROJECT OR MAKE COPIES OF THIS PAGE TO DISTRIBUTE TO STUDENTS.